

Argumentative Essay Sample

Introductory Paragraph

Anecdote

Lead-in

Thesis

Transitional
hook with 2
forward hooks

Sarah's phone went dead! The internet must have gone down, usually in this small coastal town. With the approaching cyclone, she desperately needed updates, so she turned to a small box, grateful for any sound. **This experience highlights the importance of radio, especially in times of crisis, when other technologies fail. Although often considered outdated in the technical age (counterargument), radio programs remain a key communication medium (author's argument) because they provide accessible news (supporting reason 1) and deliver important emergency information (supporting reason 2).** Although radio is considered obsolete and devoid of tech by most people, it still offers an easy way to stay informed (**Refutation**).

Body Paragraph 1 (Counterargument- *outdated in technical age*)

**Topic Sentence
with 2 reverse
hooks**

Major Details

Minor Details

**Refutation +
Transitional
hook with 2
forward hooks**

Some critics argue that radio is often considered outdated and time-consuming in the digital age. With the rise of smartphones and internet access, many (3rd Person) believe radio no longer serves as a primary source of news and entertainment. For instance, younger audiences tend to prefer apps that offer interactive features and multimedia content over traditional radio broadcasts. Additionally, critics point out that accessing information through radio can take more time compared to digital platforms. News apps, for example, allow users to scan headlines in seconds, while radio listeners often have to wait through lengthy segments or advertisements to find relevant updates. However, radio's live updates and wide reach remain vital during emergencies.

Body Paragraph 2 (Supporting reason 1 – *provides accessible news*)

Topic Sentence
with 2 reverse
hooks

Major Details

Minor Details

Transitional
hook with 2
forward hooks

Accessible news delivers real-time information and broad outreach when it matters most. **In the first place**, real-time information ensures that people stay updated on rapidly unfolding events, such as weather warnings or health emergencies, which demand immediate attention. **For instance**, during a hurricane, radio stations provide instant updates on evacuation routes and shelter locations, ensuring public safety (**Ethos**). **Moreover**, broad outreach allows individuals in rural or underserved areas to access the same vital news as those in cities, creating a sense of connection and equality (**Pathos**). This ability to provide critical alerts and guidance highlights radio's role in handling critical situations effectively.

Body Paragraph 3 (Supporting reason 2— *delivers important emerg. info*)

**Topic Sentence
with 2 reverse
hooks**

Major Details

Minor Details

Delivering important emergency information is crucial for public safety and preparedness. **In particular**, radio plays a vital role in conveying life-saving alerts during natural disasters, ensuring that everyone, regardless of their location or technology access, receives essential updates. For example, in the event of a tornado, radio broadcasts provide clear instructions on evacuation routes and safety measures, potentially saving lives (**Logos**). **Also**, the widespread availability of radio—whether through smartphones, car radios, or portable devices—ensures that even during power outages, communities remain informed.

Concluding Paragraph

**Thesis
restatement**

**Closing
Remarks/take
home message**

In conclusion, some critics may argue that radio is outdated, but it remains a vital source of news and emergency information, offering real-time updates and broad outreach. Therefore, supporters emphasize its unique ability to keep communities informed, especially in times of crisis, highlighting its continued importance in the digital age. Ultimately, radio's resilience proves that traditional media can still serve as a lifeline when modern technology fails.